PRESENTER 01 / 06

Introduction – France on the International Scene

France: an influential voice in global affairs

SPEAKING SCRIPT | Approx. 1.5 minutes

Hello everyone. Today, our presentation is about France and its role on the international stage.

France is a country in Western Europe, and its capital is Paris. It is a semi-presidential republic and one of the world's influential countries. France has an important role in international affairs because of its economy, military strength, culture and diplomatic relationships.

France is active in several major international organisations, including the European Union, the United Nations, NATO and the G7. Through these organisations, it participates in discussions about trade, security, human rights, climate change and world peace.

France also has overseas territories in different parts of the world, which gives it a presence beyond Europe.

Its foreign policy emphasises national independence, international cooperation, diplomacy and respect for international law.

In the following sections, we will explore France's role in the European Union, the United Nations, NATO and current global peace challenges.

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France and the European Union

European integration, cooperation and shared priorities

SPEAKING SCRIPT | Approx. 1.5 minutes

The European Union, or EU, is a political and economic union of 27 European countries. It was developed after the Second World War to encourage cooperation and help prevent future conflicts in Europe.

France is one of the six founding members of the European integration project. In 1950, French Foreign Minister Robert Schuman proposed cooperation between France and Germany in coal and steel production. This proposal helped lead to the European Coal and Steel Community and later the European Union.

Today, France plays an important role in EU decision-making. It participates in the European Council, the Council of the European Union and the European Parliament.

France supports cooperation in areas such as economic development, trade, climate action, technology and security. It also promotes the idea that Europe should have stronger capabilities to protect its interests and respond to international challenges.

France's EU membership provides access to the single market and strengthens cooperation with neighbouring countries.

Therefore, France is not only a member of the European Union; it is one of the countries that helped shape European unity.

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France and the United Nations

Global diplomacy, peace and international decision-making

SPEAKING SCRIPT | Approx. 1.5 minutes

The United Nations, or UN, was established in 1945 after the Second World War. Its main purposes include maintaining international peace and security, promoting human rights and encouraging cooperation between countries.

France is a founding member of the United Nations and one of the five permanent members of the UN Security Council. The other permanent members are China, Russia, the United Kingdom and the United States.

As a permanent member, France has veto power. This means it can prevent a substantive Security Council resolution from being adopted. This gives France an important role in decisions concerning international peace and security.

France also contributes to the UN through diplomacy, peacekeeping support, humanitarian action and international cooperation. It supports the importance of international law and has been active in global climate discussions. For example, the 2015 Paris Agreement on climate change was adopted at a conference hosted by France.

Through its permanent Security Council seat and wider participation in the UN, France has a significant voice in global affairs.

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France and NATO

Collective defence and strategic independence

SPEAKING SCRIPT | Approx. 1.5 minutes

NATO stands for the North Atlantic Treaty Organization. It was established in 1949 as a collective-defence alliance. Its central principle is Article 5, which states that an armed attack against one member is considered an attack against all members.

France was one of NATO's 12 founding members. However, in 1966, under President Charles de Gaulle, France withdrew from NATO's integrated military command structure because it wanted greater independence in defence and military decision-making. France did not leave NATO itself.

In 2009, France returned to NATO's integrated military command structure while retaining its independent nuclear deterrent.

Today, France contributes to NATO through military personnel, exercises, defence planning and deployments that support the security of allied countries. It also takes part in discussions about strengthening European security.

France's position combines cooperation with its allies and the desire to maintain national control over important defence decisions.

In this way, France remains an important NATO member while preserving its own strategic independence.

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France and Current Global Peace Challenges

Diplomacy and cooperation in a changing world

SPEAKING SCRIPT | Approx. 1.5 minutes

France uses diplomacy and international cooperation to respond to major global challenges.

One important issue is Russia's war against Ukraine, which escalated into a full-scale invasion in February 2022. France supports Ukraine's sovereignty and territorial integrity and works with European and international partners on diplomatic, security and humanitarian responses.

Another major issue is the Israel–Palestine conflict. France supports a two-state solution in which Israel and an independent Palestine can live side by side in peace and security. France officially recognised the State of Palestine in September 2025.

France also considers the Indo-Pacific region important because of its overseas territories and strategic interests there. It works with partners such as India on defence, maritime security, technology and regional stability. The India–France strategic partnership was established in 1998.

In 2026, France also held the G7 presidency and hosted the G7 Summit in Évian from 15 to 17 June. The G7 provides a forum for major economies to discuss international economic and political challenges.

These examples show how France uses diplomacy, partnerships and cooperation to address global problems.

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Conclusion – France’s Global Influence

Diplomacy, partnerships, security and responsibility

SPEAKING SCRIPT | Approx. 1.5 minutes

To conclude, France plays an important role in international affairs through regional cooperation, global diplomacy and collective security.

As a founding member of the European integration project, France has helped shape political and economic cooperation across Europe.

At the United Nations, its permanent Security Council membership gives it an influential role in discussions about international peace and security.

Through NATO, France contributes to collective defence while maintaining its own strategic independence.

France also engages with current global challenges, including the war in Ukraine, the Israel–Palestine conflict, Indo-Pacific security and climate change.

However, international influence also brings responsibilities. France must balance its national interests with international cooperation and work with other countries to find peaceful solutions.

Overall, France’s position in the world is shaped by diplomacy, partnerships, security and a commitment to international cooperation.

Thank you for your attention.